

Lesson 6 — WSSI Planning

Weekly Stock and Sales Intelligence: connecting sales, stock, intake and inventory cover

What is WSSI?

WSSI stands for Weekly Stock and Sales Information. It is a practical trading tool used to monitor planned and actual sales, stock, intake and key inventory measures over time.

Think of WSSI as the dashboard of a car: it does not replace the plan, but it tells the team whether the business is moving in the expected direction and where action is needed.

The basic WSSI flow

Opening Stock + Receipts – Sales = Closing Stock

The WSSI then uses the resulting stock position to review WOS, sell-through, stock-to-sales and future intake requirements.

Core WSSI columns

Opening Stock — stock available at the start of the period.

Sales Plan / Actual — expected and actual sales.

Receipts / Intake — stock planned and actually received.

Closing Stock — calculated stock remaining after sales and receipts.

WOS — Closing Stock ÷ weekly sales rate.

Sell-through — sales as a percentage of available stock, using a consistent business definition.

Why WSSI matters

WSSI helps the planner identify whether sales are ahead or behind plan, whether receipts are arriving at the right time, whether stock cover is increasing or falling, and whether future intake should be accelerated, delayed or reduced.

Illustrative 4-week WSSI

Week	Opening	Sales Plan	Receipts	Closing	WOS
1	10,000	2,500	2,000	9,500	3.8
2	9,500	2,800	1,500	8,200	2.9
3	8,200	3,000	2,500	7,700	2.6
4	7,700	3,200	3,000	7,500	2.3

How to read a WSSI

If actual sales are above plan and stock is falling faster than expected, the planner may need additional intake or replenishment. If sales are below plan and closing stock is building, the planner may review future receipts, allocation, markdown timing or assortment actions.

Practical exercise

Use the Excel workbook to build a 26-week WSSI. Enter sales plan, actual sales, planned receipts and actual receipts. Review calculated closing stock, WOS and sell-through. Use the action column to record the commercial response for weeks that move materially away from plan.

Key takeaway

WSSI turns the merchandise plan into a weekly trading control system. It helps the planner see what happened, understand the stock position and decide what action is needed next.